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Courtesy: Dubai Media Office

■ Shaikh Mohammad launched the new strategic planning cycle aimed at achieving 'We the UAE 2031 Vision'. He directed government teams to leverage legislation, AI, and future technologies to accelerate the realisation of national goals.

AI, smart efficiency key to new UAE Strategic Plan 2031

UPDATED PLAN MARKS A MAJOR SHIFT IN GOVERNANCE

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

The UAE yesterday launched the Federal Government's new Strategic Plan 2031, redefining the metrics of government success — shifting the focus from regulatory volume toward efficiency, intelligent resource use, and digital agility.

The new strategic plan was announced by His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, in a post shared on X.

Greater financial efficiency

"We have launched the new edition of the federal government's strategic plan for 2031," Shaikh Mohammad wrote. "This edition will focus on utilising artificial intelligence in planning, simplifying and reducing procedures and requirements, and achieving greater financial efficiency for the federal government.

> **Today, the measure of success in governments lies in easing regulations, ensuring seamless procedures and transactions, and using resources intelligently."**
>
> **Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum**

The updated plan represents a significant evolution in governance philosophy, with Shaikh Mohammad noting that past success metrics for governments were based on the strength of regulations, inspection teams, and comprehensive procedures.

"Proactiveness, future readiness, and strategic planning are key pillars of the distinguished governance model adopted by the UAE government. This model further strengthens the country's global standing in terms of government efficiency and excellence, supports comprehensive and sustainable development across diverse sectors, and accelerates the achievement of targets to advance national visions and strategies.

Shifting priorities

"Today, the measure of success in governments lies in easing regulations, ensuring seamless procedures and transactions, and using resources intelligently," he said. "This is a more difficult task than before.

"Tools change. Priorities shift. Plans evolve," Shaikh Mohammad concluded. "The only constant is flexibility in serving the people of the UAE."

PROPERTY

Dubai Harbour well on its way to become next property hotspot | P7

SPORT

Akash Deep finishes with 10 wickets to spur big Indian win at Edgbaston | P12

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Dubai set for self-driving car trials ahead of 2026 launch

MoU with Pony.ai marks major step in Smart Self-Driving Transport strategy



DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Senior Assistant Editor

Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Pony.ai, a global leader in autonomous driving technology, to initiate pilot trials of self-driving vehicles in the emirate.

The trials are set to begin later this year, laying the groundwork for a fully driverless commercial service targeted for launch in 2026.

The collaboration marks a major step in Dubai's Smart Self-Driving Transport Strategy, which aims to convert 25 per cent of all trips in the city to autonomous journeys by 2030.

Pony.ai recently unveiled its seventh-generation autonomous vehicle, co-developed with major automakers including Toyota, GAC, and BAIC. These vehicles feature state-of-the-art AI systems and an integrated suite of sensors — lidars, radars, and high-resolution cameras — to navigate complex road conditions safely and accurately.

UAE, Brazil strengthen bilateral ties on sidelines of Brics summit

The two nations build on their deep-rooted and long-standing relations

RIO DE JANEIRO



WAM

■ Shaikh Khalid and Lula da Silva meet for the bilateral summit in Rio de Janeiro yesterday.

Shaikh Khalid Bin Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, and Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva, President of Brazil, have discussed further advancing bilateral relations, building on the deep-rooted and long-standing ties between the two nations, which form a solid foundation for expanding cooperation across vital sectors in support of sustainable development goals and shared interests.

The meeting took place at the reception of Shaikh Khalid by the Brazilian President on the sidelines of the 17th Brics Summit.

Strength and depth

At the beginning of the meeting, the Brazilian President welcomed the visit of the Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi and the accompanying delegation, underscoring the strength and depth of bilateral relations between Brazil and the UAE.

Shaikh Khalid conveyed the greetings of President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan to Lula da Silva, along with best wishes for the Brazil President's continued health and well-being, as well as enduring progress and prosperity for Brazil and its people.

> **The meeting reviewed the progress of UAE-Brazil relations, a five-decade journey marked by sustained coordination and fruitful cooperation.**

Shaikh Khalid reaffirmed the UAE's pride in its strategic relationship with Brazil, a pioneering partnership built on decades of cooperation, mutual respect, and shared interests.

He underscored that the 50-year bond reflects the vision of both nations' leadership in fostering collaboration across vital sectors, advancing inclusive and sustainable development for the mutual benefit of both nations.

The meeting reviewed the progress of UAE-Brazil relations, a five-decade journey marked by sustained coordination and fruitful cooperation, underpinned by a shared commitment to advancing the partnership in priority sectors in line with mutual interests and evolving development objectives. — *WAM*

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